

Individual Addendum

Name: Makenzie Tatum **Team:** Kenzie-Reese-Carter **Date:** May 1, 2026

1. Personal Contribution to Capstone Milestones

Milestone 1: Data Pipeline (Week 5) — 6 hours

- Built the M1 data pipeline for FRED, mortgage, REIT, and housing price data.
- Cleaned, merged, and imputed missing values for the final analysis-ready panel.

Milestone 2: EDA Dashboard (Week 10) — 2 hours

- Reviewed M2 visualizations and confirmed dataset consistency.
- Verified lag correlation findings used to inform the M3 model.

Milestone 3: Econometric Models (Week 14) — 2 hours

- Verified M3 regression outputs, diagnostics, and robustness checks.
- Confirmed model tables and interpretations aligned with clean data evidence.

Milestone 4: Final Investment Memo (Week 14) — 7 hours

- Drafted the Executive Summary, Recommendations, and Risk sections.
- Edited memo and presentation narrative for clarity and investor readiness.

Total

- Total hours across all milestones: 17
- Estimated percentage of team workload: 50%
- Role: Data Pipeline Lead (M1), Quality Verifier (M2/M3), Memo & Presentation Lead (M4)

2. One Defended Methodological Decision

Decision: Recommended a 2-period lag on key macro variables based on M2 evidence.

- M2 showed the strongest correlations at lag 2 instead of contemporaneous timing.
- REIT financing decisions adjust over multiple quarters, so immediate rate effects are muted.
- M3 robustness checks confirmed the lagged structure produced stronger, more stable coefficients.

Alternative considered: Contemporaneous variables were rejected due to weaker significance and noisier results.

3. One Key Limitation of Our Analysis

Limitation: The FE model assumes REIT-specific unobserved factors are time-invariant.

- Portfolio shifts or sector changes may bias estimated rate sensitivity.

Potential mitigation: Future work could use sector-time interactions or a dynamic panel model.

4. AI Audit Notes

Tools used: GitHub Copilot Chat

- Revised memo language for investor clarity and structure.
- Verified AI edits manually against M3 results before acceptance.
- Critique: AI helped wording and flow; substantive analysis was validated independently.

Overall AI use: Approximately 10% of work, limited to editing and wording support.

5. Self-Reflection

Strengths: I Led M1 pipeline, verified M2/M3 outputs, and drafted the M4 memo with accurate analysis. I created the presentation and memo with accuracy and ensure correctness on my work.

Improvement: Starting M3 modeling earlier would allow deeper robustness checks. I also wish that I would have started reviewing the memo much earlier than I did.

Learned: I learned how beneficial AI can be for projects, but it must come with human review and accuracy. I feel confident in my ability to use GitHub to complete projects and code.

6. Attestation

I affirm that all contributions listed above are accurate and honest.

I have not exaggerated my role or minimized teammates' contributions.

I understand this addendum may be used to adjust my individual grade relative to the team grade.

I take responsibility for my work and any errors in the sections I authored.

Signature: Makenzie Tatum Date: May 1, 2026